全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 26 單元 | 情緒與感受 · Feelings & Emotions

Thank You for the Laughter: A Graduation Speech

謝謝那些笑聲：一篇畢業演講

Good morning, teachers, parents, and fellow graduates. Three years ago, I walked through the front gate of this school as a nervous twelve-year-old who did not know a single person. I remember the loneliness of that first week clearly: eating lunch by myself and pretending to read. I would never have guessed that I would be standing here today, trying not to become too emotional in front of all of you.

What changed everything was kindness, and it came from people in this room. Mr. Lai, our homeroom teacher, noticed that I was eating alone and quietly asked two classmates to invite me to join their science project. Those two classmates, Mei-ling and Daniel, are now my closest friends. Their enthusiasm for building a small robot was so contagious that I became fascinated by engineering, a subject I had never cared about. I am eager to study it in senior high, and that dream began with a single invitation.

I am also grateful for the laughter. Nobody will forget the day the sports fair was rained out and the whole grade had a dance contest in the hallway instead. Our teachers, who might have frowned at the noise, joined in. I think that is my deepest impression of this school: adults who treated us with patience when we were impatient, and with encouragement when we were frustrated.

So, on behalf of the graduating class, I want to express our gratitude. To our parents, thank you for the early-morning breakfasts and the late-night rides home. To our teachers, thank you for believing in us before we believed in ourselves. We leave this school hopeful, a little sentimental, and very, very thankful. Congratulations, everyone.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
loneliness	*n.*	孤單；寂寞	Moving to a new city brought him a sense of loneliness. 搬到新城市讓他感到一陣孤單。

emotional	*adj.*	情緒激動的；情感的	The farewell at the airport was very emotional. 機場的道別場面非常令人動容。
kindness	*n.*	善意；仁慈	A stranger's kindness helped me find my way in Tokyo. 一位陌生人的善意幫助我在東京找到路。
enthusiasm	*n.*	熱情	The new coach brought a lot of enthusiasm to the team. 新教練為球隊帶來了許多熱情。
fascinated	*adj.*	著迷的	The children were fascinated by the magician's tricks. 孩子們被魔術師的把戲深深吸引。
eager	*adj.*	渴望的；熱切的	The puppy was eager to go outside and play. 小狗迫不及待想出去玩。
grateful	*adj.*	感激的	I am grateful for all the help you gave me this year. 我很感激你今年給我的一切幫助。
laughter	*n.*	笑聲	Laughter filled the room when the baby made a funny face. 嬰兒做鬼臉時，房間裡充滿了笑聲。
impression	*n.*	印象	The clean streets of Kyoto left a deep impression on me. 京都乾淨的街道給我留下深刻的印象。
gratitude	*n.*	感激之情	She wrote a card to show her gratitude to the doctor. 她寫了一張卡片向醫生表達感激之情。

片語 Phrases

on behalf of	代表	The captain accepted the trophy on behalf of the team. 隊長代表球隊接受獎盃。
join in	加入；參與	Everyone was invited to join in the singing. 大家都被邀請一起加入歌唱。
believe in	相信；信任	My parents always believed in me, even when I failed. 即使我失敗了，父母也始終相信我。

文法與句型 Grammar

What + S + V ... + was / is + N

what 引導的名詞子句可以當主詞，意思是「…的事物」，用來強調句子後半的重點。文中 What changed everything was kindness 把「改變一切的東西」放在句首，再揭曉答案是善意。

What I need most now is a good night's sleep.

我現在最需要的是好好睡一覺。

S + might have + p.p.

might have + 過去分詞用來推測過去「可能發生但實際上沒有發生」的事。文中 who might have frowned at the noise 表示老師們原本可能會皺眉，但實際上他們反而加入了。

Without your help, I might have missed the last train.

沒有你的幫忙，我可能就錯過末班車了。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。